LEADERSHIP REDEFINED · YOUR POD'S CAPSTONE

Write your capstone *brief*.

Your pod picks a real problem at Vanderbilt and comes up with a way to fix it. This form is your brief: seven sections, three pages at most. Sections 1 to 3 make the case. Sections 4 to 7 lay out the plan. It is due Friday, November 20.

PROJECT TITLE

POD

POD MEMBERS

HOW TO USE THIS FORM

1. Save this file to your computer, then open it in Adobe Acrobat Reader (free) or another PDF app that fills forms.
2. Week of Nov 2: draft sections 1 to 3. Week of Nov 9: draft sections 4 to 7.
3. Week of Nov 16: meet with your pod, put your drafts together, and turn in one brief by Friday, Nov 20.
4. Questions? Post in your cohort's Teams channel.

1 Focus area

WHAT YOU WRITE — Pick one. There is one winner in each area.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE — It is at the top of page one, and the rest of the brief serves it.

- ☐ **Exceptional Core Operations** Make existing work faster, cheaper, or better.
- ☐ **Bold Strategic Initiatives** Create something new for education or research.
- ☐ **Values Driven Leadership** Advocate for and model the role of an essential research university.

2 The challenge and why it matters

WHAT YOU WRITE Who is affected, what happens today, and what it costs to wait.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE It starts with a real person and a real moment. Someone outside your office could explain it back.

3 Connection to Vanderbilt's priorities

WHAT YOU WRITE The part of the vision your idea serves. What it costs, and who pays after year one.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE It names the vision and your focus area, not just "strategy."

4 Integrated solution

WHAT YOU WRITE What changes for people, process, and technology, and who shares the credit.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE All three change together, and all six program topics show up.

5 Steps, owners, timeline

WHAT YOU WRITE One line per step: what happens, who owns it, and by when.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE It starts with a small pilot, and every step has an owner and a date.

6 Success metrics

WHAT YOU WRITE Two or three ways you will know it worked.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE Each has a starting number, a target, and a date, and measures results, not activity.

7 Sustainability plan

WHAT YOU WRITE Who keeps it going after your pod, and how year two is paid for.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE One clear owner, and a plan that makes it normal work.

FOR PRACTICE

A strong *example*.

An invented example, for practice: using gigs to cut what we spend on outside contractors.

THE CASE · SECTIONS 1 TO 3

1	**Focus area**	Exceptional Core Operations.
2	**The challenge**	Departments pay contractors and consultants for short projects, like data analysis and web updates, that our own staff could do. The money leaves, and staff who want to grow go elsewhere.
3	**Connection**	The vision asks us to operate with speed, agility and scale. Using skills we already have keeps fees inside Vanderbilt.

THE PLAN · SECTIONS 4 TO 7

4	**Solution**	People: managers share up to 10% of a staff member's time for a gig. Process: before hiring outside help for a short project, post it as a gig for two weeks. Technology: gigs are posted and matched in the Talent Marketplace.
5	**Steps**	Weeks 1 to 4, set the gig rules with Procurement (HR lead). Weeks 5 to 16, pilot in two divisions. Week 17, review results with sponsors.
6	**Metrics**	Contractor and consulting spend in the pilot divisions drops 15% from last year by June. Staff fill 25 gigs.
7	**Sustainability**	HR's Talent Marketplace team owns it after the pilot. The gig check becomes a standard step before hiring a contractor.